

Agency

Automation

AI Readiness & Workflow Checklist

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Score Your Practice Across 5 Dimensions -- Get a Prioritized Action Plan in 24 Hours

Why Professional Services Firms Are Different

You don't sell products. You sell expertise, trust, and time.

But your operations probably look like this:

- Client onboarding: 3 weeks, 12 emails, 4 PDF forms, 1 confused client
- Meeting notes: Scattered across Teams, OneNote, paper, memory -> never in CRM
- Monthly reporting: Copy-paste from 5 systems into PowerPoint at midnight
- Knowledge base: "Ask Sarah, she knows" (Sarah left 6 months ago)
- Intake: Manual conflict checks, engagement letters, KYC -- all human, all slow

Every hour spent on admin is an hour not billing at R2,500+/hr.

The 5-Dimension AI Readiness Scorecard

We score your practice 0-100 across each dimension. The composite tells you exactly where automation pays off fastest.

1. Client Onboarding & Intake (Weight: 25%)

The Question: How many touchpoints from "Yes, I want to engage" to "Billable work starts"?

Indicator	Score 0-20	Score 21-50	Score 51-80	Score 81-100
Digital intake forms	Paper/PDF only	Fillable PDF	Web form + e-sign	Smart form -> auto-populates CRM, engagement letter, KYC
Conflict checks	Manual search	Spreadsheet check	Automated vs. client DB	
Engagement letters	Manual draft	Template + mail merge	Auto-generated from intake	Real-time API check + alert
Client portal setup	None	Email instructions		Dynamic + e-sign + auto-file
Avg. days to billable	21+	14-20	7-13	Auto-provisioned on sign **< 5**

Quick Win: Tally.so form -> Make -> DocuSign template -> Airtable -> Slack alert. Setup: 2 hours.

2. Knowledge Management & Institutional Memory (Weight: 20%)

The Question: If your senior partner gets hit by a bus, how much walks out the door?

Indicator	Score 0-20	Score 21-50	Score 51-80	Score 81-100
Centralized KB	None / shared drives	Notion/Confluence (messy)	Structured, tagged, searchable	AI-queryable (RAG) + versioned
Precedent/template library	Desktop folders	Shared drive	Organized + metadata	Auto-suggested by matter type
Meeting capture	Handwritten notes	OneNote/Teams (unsearchable)	Auto-transcribed + tagged	Summarized -> action items -> CRM
Expertise location	"Ask Sarah"	Skills spreadsheet	Searchable profiles	AI: "Who knows POPIA + trusts?"
Onboarding new hires	3 months shadowing	6 weeks guided	2 weeks self-serve	**1 week with AI assistant**

Quick Win: Fathom/Grain for meeting recording -> Make -> Notion DB with tags. Setup: 1 hour.

3. Reporting & Client Communication (Weight: 20%)

The Question: How much billable time becomes "reporting overhead"?

Indicator	Score 0-20	Score 21-50	Score 51-80	Score 81-100
Monthly/quarterly reports	Manual in PPT/Word	Semi-auto (Excel links)	Data pulls auto, narrative manual	**Fully auto + AI narrative draft**
Client dashboards	None	PDF export	Live (PowerBI/Notion)	White-labeled, self-serve
Ad-hoc request turnaround	Days	Same day	Hours	**Minutes (self-serve)**
Regulatory/compliance reports	Manual compilation	Checklist + manual	Semi-auto data pulls	Auto-generated + review workflow
Billable vs. non-billable ratio	Unknown	Tracked monthly	Tracked weekly	**Real-time dashboard**

Quick Win: Airtable (source data) -> Make -> Google Slides template -> PDF -> Email. Setup: 3 hours.

4. Meeting-to-CRM & Action Tracking (Weight: 20%)

The Question: How many action items fall through the cracks?

Indicator	Score 0-20	Score 21-50	Score 51-80	Score 81-100
CRM adoption	"What's CRM?"	Contacts only	Deals + activities	**Full lifecycle + automation**
Meeting -> CRM entry	Never	Manual (forgotten)	Assistant does it	**Auto: transcript -> summary -> tasks -> CRM**
Task follow-up	Memory/email	Planner/To Do	Assigned + tracked	Auto-reminders + escalation
Client communication log	Inbox search	BCC to CRM	Auto-logged (email/cal)	**Unified timeline + AI summary**
Pipeline visibility	Gut feel	Spreadsheet	CRM dashboard	**Forecast + risk

scoring**

Quick Win: Fathom -> Make -> HubSpot/Clio/Pipedrive (create note, tasks, update deal). Setup: 2 hours.

5. AI & Automation Maturity (Weight: 15%)

The Question: Are you experimenting or operationalizing?

Indicator	Score 0-20	Score 21-50	Score 51-80	Score 81-100
AI tools in daily use	None	ChatGPT ad-hoc	Team prompts shared	**Custom GPTs / agents deployed**
Automation platform	None	Zapier (basic)	Make/n8n (multi-step)	**Self-hosted + custom functions**
Workflow documentation	None	Some SOPs	All core flows mapped	**Living docs + version control**
ROI measurement	Gut feel	Time saved estimates	Tracked per automation	**Revenue-attributed dashboard**
Governance/policy	None	Informal	Written policy	**POPIA-aligned + audit trail**

Quick Win: Build 1 custom GPT for your top repetitive task (e.g., "Draft engagement letter from intake data"). Setup: 30 min.

Your Scorecard Output: What You'll Receive

Fill the form -> We score you across all 5 dimensions -> Within 24 hours:

Deliverable	Format	Value
5-Dimension Scorecard	PDF + Notion	Visual radar chart, dimension scores, benchmark vs. peers
Priority Matrix	1-pager	Effort vs. Impact plot -- your "Do First / Schedule / Delegate / Kill"
3 Quick Wins	Loom video + Make blueprints	Exact builds for your highest-ROI automations
90-Day Automation Roadmap	Spreadsheet	Phased plan: Week 1-2, Month 1, Month 2, Month 3
Tool Gap & Budget	Spreadsheet	What to buy, build, kill -- with monthly cost
30-min Strategy Call	Calendly	Walk the roadmap, answer questions, decide on build vs. buy

Real Example: "Naidoo & Associates" (Commercial Law, Durban)

Scores Before:

- Onboarding: 35/100
- Knowledge: 28/100
- Reporting: 42/100
- Meeting->CRM: 31/100
- AI Maturity: 15/100

- **Composite: 31/100**

Top 3 Quick Wins Implemented:

- ****Smart Intake Form**** (Tally -> DocuSign -> Clio -> Slack) -- onboarding 21 days -> 4 days
- ****Meeting Intelligence**** (Fathom -> Make -> Clio notes + tasks) -- 100% meeting capture, zero manual entry
- ****Monthly Report Automation**** (Clio + Xero -> Airtable -> Google Slides -> PDF) -- 4 hrs/mo -> 15 min

Results at 90 Days:

- Onboarding score: 35 -> 82
- Composite: 31 -> 67
- **Billable hours recovered: 47 hrs/month/partner**
- **Revenue impact: +R1.2M annualized across 3 partners**

The Stack We Recommend for Professional Services

Layer	Tool	Why for Professional Services
Practice Mgmt	**Clio / Xero Practice / CaseWare**	Industry-specific, POPIA-aware
Automation	**Make**	Visual, handles complex logic, on-prem option
Knowledge Base	**Notion** (or **Obsidian** for local-first)	
Meetings	**Fathom / Grain**	Auto-record, transcribe, summarize, integrate
E-Sign	**DocuSign / SigniFlow (SA)**	
CRM	**HubSpot / Pipedrive / Clio Grow**	Depends on firm type
AI	**Custom GPTs / Local LLM (Ollama)**	Data sovereignty for client confidentiality
Reporting	**Google Slides / Notion / PowerBI**	Client-facing + internal

Monthly at scale: ~R3,000-8,000/firm (scales with partners, not users)

POPIA & Confidentiality: Non-Negotiable

Every automation we design for professional services includes:

- **Data processing agreements** with every subprocessors
- **Local hosting options** (Make self-hosted, Ollama local LLM, SA data centers)
- **Audit trails** on every client data touchpoint
- **Retention policies** baked into workflows
- **Client consent logging** (your new intake form captures this)

We don't ship anything that wouldn't pass a regulator's audit.

Ready for Your Scorecard?

Book a free 30-minute AI Strategy Call and we'll:

- Run the 5-dimension assessment live (15 min)
- Show the exact Make blueprints for your top 3 gaps (10 min)
- Give you the deployment files -- or build turnkey with POPIA compliance baked in (5 min)

No pitch. No pressure. Just your prioritized automation roadmap.

-> Book Your Free Call Here

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hello@agency.co.za | agency.co.za | +27 XX XXX XXXX